PassFrame
TUITION

Autumn's Arrival

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

The leaves begin to turn and fall,
like golden coins from branches tall,
and scatter soft across the ground,
a crunching, rustling, russet sound.

The air grows sharp, the mornings grey,
and breath hangs white and drifts away;
the swallows gather, wing to wing,
preparing for their journeying.

The squirrel hides his hoarded store
of acorns, counted three times more,
while hedgehogs curl in leafy beds
and tuck their noses, sleepy heads.

The harvest moon hangs low and round,
a lantern lit above the ground,
and farmers gather in the grain
before the coming autumn rain.

So though the summer's warmth has fled,
and softer light hangs low instead,
there's beauty too in fading light,
in amber days and quiet night.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What sound do the leaves make according to the first verse?

2. What does the squirrel do with his acorns?

3. Underline the line that tells you breath becomes visible in the cold air.

4. Underline the rhyming pair of words in the third verse.

5. What does “journeying” suggest the swallows are about to do?

6. Put these events in order: the harvest moon rises / leaves begin to fall / hedgehogs curl up to sleep / farmers gather in the grain.

7. Why might the poet have chosen the word “russet” (a reddish-brown colour) to describe the leaves' sound?

8. What are hedgehogs described as doing in the third verse?

9. Why do you think the poet mentions the squirrel counting his acorns “three times more”?

10. What does the final verse suggest the poet wants readers to feel about the end of summer?

11. Find and copy a word from the poem that means “stored away carefully, often secretly”.

12. Write one or two sentences describing your own favourite sign that a new season has arrived.